GMS WEEKLY

Your Source for Recycling News

December 26th, 2025
Week 52
Volume 279, Issue 1217

Highlights:

- **Turbulent year.**
- **Scarce supply.**
- **Freight still high?**
- **HKC catch up.**
- **Season's Wishes!**
- **Scan to download / view the Weekly on the GMS App!**

QUOTE of the WEEK

"Courage is like a muscle. We strengthen it by use."

– Ruth Gordo

-- MARKET COMMENTARY --

Click "Ctrl" + below to launch the GMS Weekly Summary Podcast

AU REVOIR, 2025!

A turbulent 2025 — not only for the ship recycling industry, but for global economies churning under the weight of tariffs, tantrums, and tumultuous international situations — finally comes to a close, there were certainly some positive highlights to note as remarkable progress on HKC infrastructure upgrades has been carried out across the entire Indian sub-continent ship recycling industry right before the year-end — a leaving a positive mark for the ship recycling industry and certainly a welcome sign for 2026.

Yet, the glaring fact remains that prices are far poorer than the USD 600/ton highs of January 2024, driven by consistently declining steel plate prices across the Indian sub-continent markets, coupled with incredible volatility in global currencies/foreign exchange trading, never-ending political events, and a touch of monsoon rainstorms that even brought the weather into the mix. As such, markets continue to shift and slide, while the ongoing scarcity in vessel supply remains ever consistent. It has also been a quiet week at the bidding tables (Christmas mood notwithstanding) and another largely uneventful — and eerily quiet — year on the recycling waterfront, punctuated occasionally by the odd large LDT LNG and older bulker.

But that we hope will change going into 2026, as the Baltic Exchange continued reporting downward trajectory for the dry sectors, falling another 0.8% this week to its lowest levels since October. The decline was driven by an overall retreat in capes (down 0.5%) and the smaller segments that shed 18 basis points. Oil on the other hand, managed to climb to USD 57.21/barrel — a 0.82% increase this week — yet it registered an overall 3.56% drop across December, and a 19.2% overall decline compared to the same time last year. Local steel plate prices, too, surprisingly donned new hats this week, shifting from rising, to falling, to flat-out lack of trading.

As 2026 rolls around next week, and with many expecting freight markets to continue performing into the first half of 2026, the introduction of vessels for recycling could therefore be potentially delayed even further — at least until surveys and dry dockings start kicking in. Hopefully, this delay should create the opportunity for both Pakistan and Bangladesh to make meaningful progress on their HKC journeys, as more yards are expected to be approved by then and ready to take on fresh units in 2026, in line with the Hong Kong Convention.

As 2026 looms and a quiet week ensues, we at GMS wish all our readers and friends, a Happy Christmas and a Happy, Healthy, and Prosperous New Year ahead!

GMS demo rankings / pricing for week 52 of 2025 are on Page 6.

BANGLADESH

SLIGHT STAIN!

Positive fourth quarter.

The decline in sentiment and pricing that accelerated toward the end of the year has left a slight stain on what has otherwise been a comparatively healthier (for what it's worth) fourth quarter. Prices have indeed cooled off noticeably from the Bangladeshi corner of the bidding table, and as many of the open and capable yards took in a good bit of tonnage during November's buffet storm, a shortage of "locally available" reselling options for shipowners and cash buyers looking to fix tonnage has come under severe strain this month.

Yards filling.

Notwithstanding, throughout the year, we have seen a collection of larger LDT vessels sold into Bangladesh, including LNGs, mini capes, a collection of large(r) tankers, and several comparatively cheaper green units for recycling. As this has significantly affected December sentiments around how conventional vessels should be priced, it seems the net effect will now be to drag down local offerings even further once the market is eventually back in play.

Cheap green affects.

What **is** dragging down the local ship recycling fraternity are domestic fundamentals, which continue to display unexpected movements week after week. This week, the Bangladeshi taka managed to firm a mere five basis points against the U.S. Dollar and close at BDT 122.22. But it was local steel plate prices that won the fancy-dress competition as, reportedly, there was a dead halt in local trading, resulting in levels being truly flat on the floor.

Another surprise was local anchorage, which reported a healthy number of arrivals / deliveries, marking the end of the final beaching tide of the year and the closing of books for some buyers. It also clearly highlighted improving performance and speed of inward-clearance formalities at Chattogram anchorage, as some units arrived and were even delivered within days.

Cheap way is up.

Yet, with the nearing of Election Day on February 14, 2026, political violence continues to mar the streets of the nation's capital, as growing instability is being reported across key political jurisdictions not only in Chattogram, but reportedly across the nation.

Overall, for 2026, Bangladesh seems more optimistically placed on the ship recycling front — and should the political cards fall in favor of the populace, then hopefully the wider economy as well. It seems that for Bangladesh, as a nation, the only way from here is up.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

INDIA

UNTAPPED POTENTIAL!

India remains planted firmly at the foot of the global ship recycling market rankings for yet another week/month, capping off an overall miserable year of declining rates, a frighteningly depreciating currency, and collapsing local steel prices that seem to have lost track of time and space.

Planted at foot.

As competing sub-continent markets continue to catch up on the number of HKC-accredited yards in their respective corners, Alang recyclers seem to have missed their opportunity to use their HKC status to their advantage this year, despite the overall dearth of tonnage that has still managed to produce sporadic phases of inflow of tonnage into competing nations – including HKC units.

Missed opportunity.

But what a year it has truly been for Indian fundamentals — both local steel plate prices and the Indian Rupee, and especially the Rupee over the last two quarters. While local steel plate prices started the year around USD 462/ton and ended the final week of 2026 at a noteworthy USD 393/ton (a USD 70/ton drop), it was the Rupee's rapid descent that stole the show, with levels across the year declining from a low of Rs. 85.30 to above Rs. 91, and clocking week 52 out at Rs. 89.80 against the U.S. Dollar.

Yet, the nation overall remains in a better economic posture than before, as inflation rises to gradually scoop the country out of stagflation territory. And while economic talks with the White House are reportedly still ongoing, 2025 has been a strong economic year for India, with GDP expanding over 8% in key quarters where projections hovered around 6.5%–7%.

2026 hopes.

Overall, there are still reasons to be hopeful going into 2026, as more vessels are expected to come for recycling (eventually), which may finally help Alang plots begin to fill their quotas once again.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

PAKISTAN

STARVED PRIDE!

First HKC.

As 2025 draws to a close, Pakistan can only look back with pride as the nation's first HKC-approved ship recycling yard joined the international fray — not only for Pakistan, but as a first step onto the global stage.

While earlier in the year, it seemed like an impossibility for Pakistan to catch up with HKC yard-upgrade requirements within 2025 (given how far behind local progress staggered), serious investments and infrastructure updates have taken place in the interim to speed up the process. And with many more yards reportedly on the way scheduled for Q1 2026 approvals, Pakistan may become the one market capable of putting a serious dent into India's HKC prowess west of Bangladesh.

Serious work.

Adding to Gadani's favor, and unlike its neighboring competition, are Pakistan's fundamentals that have remained comparatively tame and stronger. The PKR gained four basis points to close a year that started at PKR 278.30 against the U.S. Dollar, at PKR 280.13. And despite a USD 80/ton drop, local steel plate prices remained flatlined through the week at around USD 580/ton (well ahead of the competition), having started the year near USD 640/ton.

While Gadani buyers did get back to buying with a mid-year spree, thanks to firmer fundamentals and timing, this was not at sustained throughput as imports of cheap Iranian steel products started to hammer local sentiment — and local offer levels for tonnage as a result.

Back to buying.

Yet, like Chattogram, with inflation now declining last month, relatively stable fundamentals, and only additions to the number of HKC-accredited ship recycling yards, the only way for the Gadani Gang in 2026 is up.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

TURKEY

QUIET!

Lethargy.

The Turkish Lira lost 24 basis points against the U.S. Dollar to close the week out at TRY 42.92, having started the year at TRY 35.08 — a near 15% decline for the currency. Beyond that, it was a quiet overall year; and, like Pakistan, the sporadic inflow of tonnage was meted out to local recyclers like mercy through a drought.

Beyond that, we can only hope that with a hopefully increased inflow of tonnage, volumes will help Aliaga recyclers beat the lethargy odds.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

GMS Weekly – Market Rankings

For Week 52 of 2025, GMS Market Rankings / vessel indications are as below.

Rank	Location	Sentiment	Dry Bulk USD / LDT	Tankers USD / LDT	Containers USD / LDT
1	Bangladesh	**Weak**	410 / LDT	430 / LDT	440 / LDT
2	Pakistan	**Weak**	400 / LDT	420 / LDT	430 / LDT
3	India	**Weak**	380 / LDT	400 / LDT	410 / LDT
4	Turkey	**Steady**	270 / LDT	280 / LDT	290 / LDT

2025's GIFTS!!

- ***Science & Technology***
  - *New Color: A new color, "olo," described as a teal-blue, was reportedly discovered or created.*
  - *AI Growth: AI spending accounted for a significant portion (92%) of U.S. GDP growth in the first half of the year, according to one calculation.*
  - *CRISPR Breakthrough: The first child received gene editing to fix a specific DNA mutation using CRISPR.*
  - *Honda's Self-Balancing Bike: Honda showcased tech allowing a motorcycle to stay upright and even follow a person walking.*
  - *The U.S. releases 100 million sterile flies in Mexico every week.*
- *Politics & Society*
  - *New Leaders: Japan (Sanae Takaichi) and Namibia (Netumbo Nandi-Ndaitwah) inaugurated their first women heads of government.*
  - *Papal History: Robert Prevost was elected as Pope Leo XIV, the first American Pope.*
  - *Global Shifts: Political transitions occurred in the U.S., Canada, Germany, and Nepal, with increased global instability and conflict.*
- *Space & Astronomy*
  - *Commercial Moon Landing: Firefly Aerospace's "Blue Ghost" achieved the first successful commercial soft landing on the Moon.*
  - *Satellites can spot the hot breath geysering out of a single whale's blowhole.*

IMPORTANT DATES

INDIA	
BANK HOLIDAYS	**DELIVERY TIDES**
December 31 – New Year's Eve January 01 – New Years Day January 14 – Pongal January 26 – Republic Day	January 01 – January 08 January 17 – January 24

BANGLADESH	
BANK HOLIDAYS	**DELIVERY TIDES**
December 31 – Bank Holiday **No Holidays in January**	*Awaiting Tide Schedule*

BANK HOLIDAYS	
PAKISTAN	**TURKEY**
January 01 – Bank Holiday	January 01 – National Holiday

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ALANG - Port Position as of December 26, 2025

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	*Asena*	*3,196*	*General Cargo*	*Delivered December 18*
2	***Conica Atlas***	***20,001***	***Oil Tanker***	
3	Mackerel	8,868	Oil Tanker	Delivered December 20
4	*Morality*	*9,852*	*Oil Tanker*	*Delivered December 11*
5	*Prestige*	*3,307*	*Oil Tanker*	*Delivered December 19*
Morality		**45,224**		

CHATTOGRAM - Port Position as of December 2026, 2025

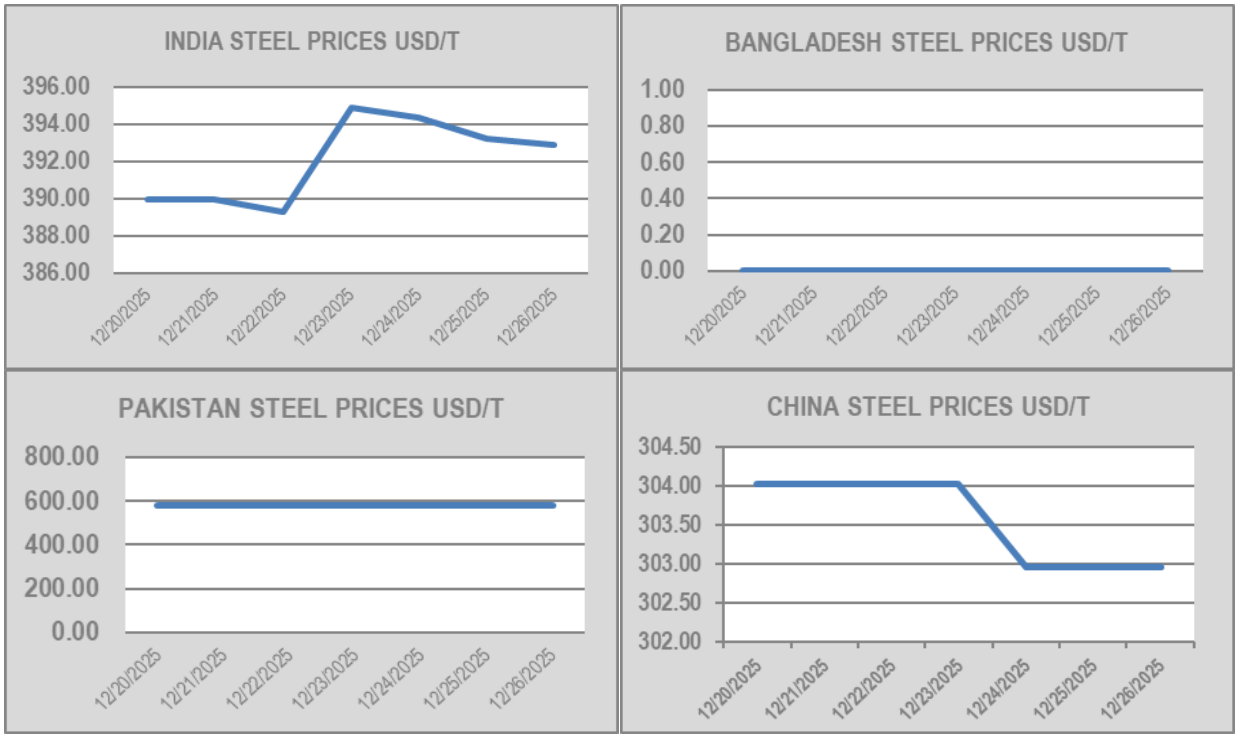
No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	*Bold Mariner*	*7,507*	*Bulk Carrier*	*Delivered December 23*
2	*Elite Prosperity (Under Tow)*	*13,733*	*Barge*	*Delivered December 23*
3	*Fan Shun*	*7,690*	*Bulk Carrier*	*Delivered December 20*
4	*Jessica*	*2,563*	*Tanker*	*Delivered December 25*
5	*Unnggul*	*1,238*	*Cement Carrier*	*Delivered December 24*
6	*Zi Yu Lan*	*7,542*	*MPP*	*Delivered December 25*
		40,273		

GADANI - Port Position as of December 2026, 2025

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	*Ardhianto*	*2,922*	*General Cargo*	*Delivered December 20*
Total Tonnage		**2,922**		

WHILE EXTREME CARE HAS BEEN TAKEN IN THE PREPARATION OF THIS REPORT, NO LIABILITY CAN BE ACCEPTED FOR ANY LOSS INCURRED IN ANY WAY WHATSOEVER BY ANY PERSON RELYING ON THE INFORMATION CONTAINED HEREIN.

DATE	INDIA STEEL PRICES USD/T	INDIA STEEL PRICES	PAKISTAN STEEL PRICES USD/T	PAKISTAN STEEL PRICES	BANGLADESH STEEL PRICES USD/T	BANGLADESH STEEL PRICES	CHINA STEEL PRICES USD/T
12/20/2025	389.94	34,900.00	579.86	163,000.00	NO TRADING	NO TRADING	304.04
12/21/2025	389.94	34,900.00	579.86	163,000.00	NO TRADING	NO TRADING	304.04
12/22/2025	389.29	34,900.00	579.86	163,000.00	NO TRADING	NO TRADING	304.04
12/23/2025	394.87	35,400.00	579.86	163,000.00	NO TRADING	NO TRADING	304.04
12/24/2025	394.34	35,400.00	579.86	163,000.00	NO TRADING	NO TRADING	302.96
12/25/2025	393.23	35,300.00	579.86	163,000.00	NO TRADING	NO TRADING	302.96
12/26/2025	392.92	35,300.00	579.86	163,000.00	NO TRADING	NO TRADING	302.96



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